

2c. Content of Studies and applications in psychology 2

This component introduces learners to the following topics: Social Influence, Memory and Sleep and Dreaming.

Learners must demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the key concepts, theories/ explanations, related research studies and application listed.

For the research studies the following must be studied: background, method (design, sample, materials/apparatus, procedure), results, conclusions and criticisms.

Learners are also required to have studied all content relating to planning research, doing research and analysing research (see section 2c Content of Research Methods (Components 01 and 02)).

Learners are encouraged to carry out ethical, investigative practical activities appropriate for the study of psychology at this level, but learners will not be directly assessed on these specific activities.

Social Influence	Content:
Key Concepts	- Conformity including majority influence. - Collective and crowd behaviour including pro-social and anti-social behaviour. - Obedience including obeying the orders of authority figures.
Theories/Explanations Situational Factors Dispositional Factors	- The effect of situational factors (other people and social) on behaviours: - majority influence on conformity - collective and crowd behaviour, including deindividuation - culture on pro-social and anti-social behaviour - authority figures on obedience - criticisms of the effect of situational factors, including the free will/determinism debate. Situational Factors Research Study - Bickman (1974): study into obedience and the social power of a uniform. - The effect of dispositional factors (personality) on behaviours: - self-esteem on conformity - locus of control in crowds - morality on pro-social and anti-social behaviour - the authoritarian personality on obedience <u>the influence of the brain in dispositional factors, including: hippocampal volume in self-esteem; and regions of the pre-frontal cortex in morality</u> - criticisms of the effect of dispositional factors including issues of generalisability. Dispositional Factors Research Study - NatCen (2011): study into the August riots in England with reference to anti-social collective behaviour and dispositional factors. (Note: candidates only need to be familiar with the events in Tottenham.)